

All change

Chlorine keeps the water in swimming pools clean and safe to swim in. It is made in a factory by passing electricity through salty water. The electric current makes the atoms in the salt and water rearrange, and produces chlorine.



The gases that come out of the top of the tower are made into plastics.

One-fifth of each barrel of crude oil separates into gasoline.



Gasoline is the most common fuel used to power cars.

When the cloud of crude oil reaches this height, it is cool enough for diesel to turn into a liquid.



Diesel is the fuel used by many trains.

A different oil flows out of each pipe because all the oils in crude oil cool into liquids at different temperatures.



Dark industrial oil is burned in factories and power stations.

Bitumen is the first oil to flow out of the tower.



Thick, sticky bitumen is spread on the surface of roads.

Catalytic cracker

Oil is made up of long chains of carbon and hydrogen atoms. Useful chemicals, called petrochemicals, are made by breaking up these chains. This is done by heating the oil in tanks called catalytic crackers. The small chains can be used to make useful things such as shampoo.



Hydrogen atoms are forced between the carbon atoms to break up the chain.



Super sulphur

About 165 million tons of sulphuric acid are used every year to help make things such as fertilizer, paper, and explosives. This acid is made by heating a yellow rock called sulphur.

